

Building a Skincare Routine

Prescribing for a real person — across type, climate, season, and budget

Learning Objectives

- Design a complete AM and PM routine for any skin type or condition
- Apply the correct layering order and explain why sequence matters
- Adapt a routine for the Indian seasons and for any climate
- Prescribe honestly across every budget — and write a professional skincare prescription

From treating to prescribing

A facial lasts an hour. A routine lasts a lifetime. The most lasting thing you give a client is not the treatment on your table but the ritual you send home with her.

The treatment is what you do for her. The routine is what you teach her to do for herself. The second is the greater gift.

The architecture of a routine

The morning (AM) routine protects. Its job is to defend the skin against the day.

- Cleanser (gentle — the skin has only rested, not laboured)
- Antioxidant serum, classically vitamin C — defends against environmental damage
- Moisturiser — appropriate to the type
- Sunscreen — the non-negotiable final step

The evening (PM) routine repairs. Its job is to undo the day and support overnight renewal.

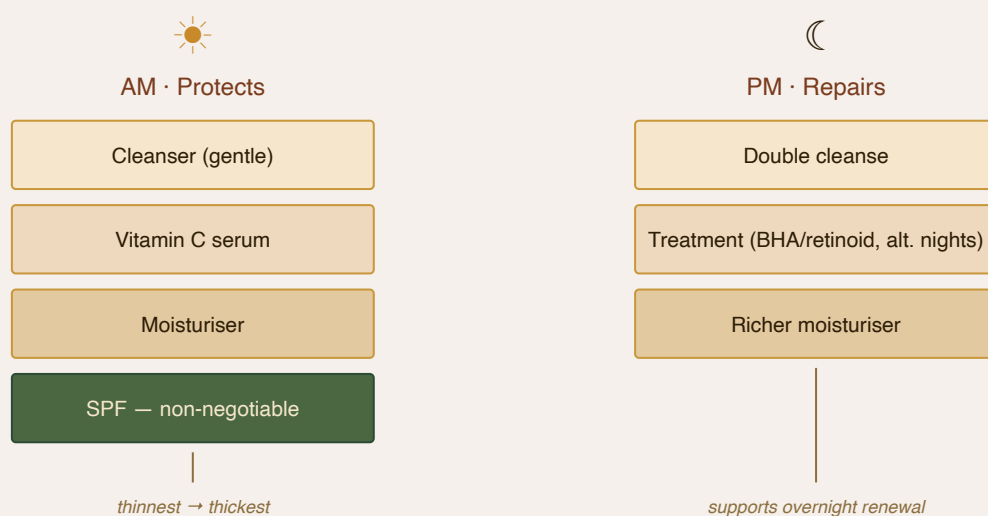
- Double cleanse — to remove sunscreen, pollution, makeup, sebum

- Treatment — a retinoid, or an exfoliant on its appointed nights (recall the conflicts from Module Four)
- Moisturiser, perhaps richer than the morning's

Why layering order matters

The rule is simple: **thinnest to thickest, water-based before oil-based**. A heavy cream applied first forms a seal that a watery serum cannot then penetrate.

◆ Figure 13.1 · AM Protects / PM Repairs



Morning and evening routines, layered thinnest to thickest, water-based before oil-based.

The Indian skin calendar

- **The monsoon** — humidity high, skin often oilier and prone to congestion; lighter textures, careful cleansing.
- **The North Indian winter** — dry, cold air pulling moisture from the skin; richer moisturisers, gentler exfoliation.
- **The summer** — heat, sweat, relentless sun; lightweight hydration, scrupulous sun protection.

Prescribing across every budget

Luxury is knowledge, not price. A practitioner who can only recommend the expensive thing is not skilled — she is merely costly. True skill is building a genuinely effective routine at any budget, because you understand *ingredients*, not brands.

Priya — the routine, at last

You have carried her since Module Three. *Priya, 28, Fitzpatrick Type V, Mumbai. Grade II jawline acne, visible PIH, skin tight and dull despite daily moisturiser, and a "fairness" cream she should gently be guided away from.*

- **First, the redirection.** The fairness cream is retired — kindly — and replaced with the Amber promise: not lighter skin, but clear, even, healthy skin.
- **Her AM:** gentle gel cleanser; niacinamide serum (calms acne, fades PIH); light moisturiser; broad-spectrum sunscreen, explained as the single most powerful thing she can do for her dark marks.
- **Her PM:** double cleanse; BHA on two or three nights; on alternate nights, a gentle retinoid — never the same night as the BHA; barrier-supporting moisturiser.
- **The seasonal note:** lighter through the monsoon; richer in any drier spell.
- **The honest timeline:** breakouts calm in weeks; PIH fades over months, with faithful sun protection.

Key Terms

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Prescription Activity · Complete Priya's Routine

Write Priya's complete AM and PM routine in full, with a real example product at three price points. Add a seasonal note and honest timeline. **Keep it for your capstone.**